Designing with the AI

Your cheat sheet for trying ideas in the real app. Nothing you do here reaches the team's code, and nothing is lost.

EVERY DAY

1. **Open OpenCode** and pick the project. Every chat starts with your design partner, the AI.
2. **Type** `/start-app` (or say "start the app"). The app opens in its own window. The first time, and after the team changes the app's building blocks, this takes a few minutes. A small "Design app" window sits in the taskbar while the app runs: don't close it, it keeps the app running.
3. **Describe what you want to see.** The AI changes the app and tells you where to look. The app window updates by itself; when you switch versions, the AI restarts the app for a moment.
4. **Like it? Save it.** Type `/save-version` or just say "save this". Saved versions can always be opened again.

FOUR WORDS TO KNOW

Idea
A design direction you work on, like "new checkout".

Version
A saved moment of an idea: version 1, 2, 3 and so on.

Unsaved changes
Everything changed since the version you have open.

The team's code
The developers' newest app, without your ideas.

WHAT TO TYPE

Type `/` in OpenCode to see every command. You can always just ask in your own words instead.

YOU WANT TO	TYPE	OR SAY
Save what you see	`/save-version Bigger buttons`	*"Save this as bigger buttons"*
See your ideas and versions	`/versions`	*"Show my versions"*
Open a saved version	`/open-version checkout 2`	*"Go back to the one with the blue header"*
Start a new idea	`/new-idea`	*"Start a new idea for the settings page"*
Get the team's newest code	`/get-latest`	*"Get the latest from the team"*
Bring that into your idea	`/update-idea`	*"Update my idea with the team's changes"*
Take back the AI's last design change	`/undo`	*"Undo your last change"*
Throw away unsaved changes	`/discard-changes`	*"Go back to my last saved version"*
Check where you are	`/where-am-i`	*"Which version am I on?"*
See the app without your ideas	`/team-code`	*"Show me the app as the team has it"*
Start or restart the app	`/start-app`	*"The app isn't showing"*
Something looks wrong or lost	`/fix-problems`	*"Something is broken, help"*
See what you can ask	`/help-me`	*"What can you do?"*

GETTING GOOD RESULTS

- **Be specific.** Say where, what and how much: "On the order page, make the Buy button 48 px tall, colour #1A73E8, with 16 px space above it."
- **One change at a time.** Small steps are easier to judge and to undo.
- **Point at what exists.** "Use the same card style as on the dashboard."
- **The AI can't see pictures.** Describe a mockup in words: layout from top to bottom, sizes, colours as hex codes, fonts.
- **One chat per idea.** Start a new chat (New session, or `/new`) when you switch ideas or when answers get slow.
- **Save when you like something,** even small steps. Versions cost nothing.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Nothing is lost.** Before anything is thrown away, the AI keeps a backup. Ask "find what I threw away yesterday" and it can bring it back.
- **Your versions stay on this computer.** They are never sent to the team. To show a concept, invite a developer to your screen; the AI can write a short summary of what changed.
- **Old versions stay the same.** Getting the team's newest code never changes them.
- **/undo is for design changes only.** Use it right after a change you don't like, not after saving, opening a version or getting the latest.
- **When the AI asks you something,** it shows buttons. Click the answer that fits, or type your own.
- **Stuck?** Type `/fix-problems`. If that doesn't help, ask Sebastian. There is no rush: your work is safe.

A typical session: "Start a new idea for a simpler checkout." → "Put the order summary on the right and make it sticky." → "Make the total bold and 20 px." → "Save this." → next day: "Get the latest from the team and update my idea."